

Dear Reader,

Elizabeth II has reigned for longer than any other queen in world history. In the UK, Queen Victoria's reign had lasted for 63 years and 216 days. Elizabeth broke her great-great-grandmother's record on September 9, 2015.

Elizabeth was never supposed to be queen—she only became next in line to the throne when a twist of fate made her father the king. She grew up during World War II, married and had children. Royal life was briefly normal. With the death of her father, all changed again. Elizabeth was queen, and had a duty for life.

Being queen means being on public show. Although the queen has no real power, and does not vote, she has endless government business to read, and she signs each new law. She has traveled the world and has been photographed perhaps more than anyone else. Yet the woman behind this royal image is seen by very few. Elizabeth had promised that her life would be one of service, and had dedicated her life to doing her duty. In that she has never wavered—an example to all.

Happy reading,
Brenda and Brian Williams

